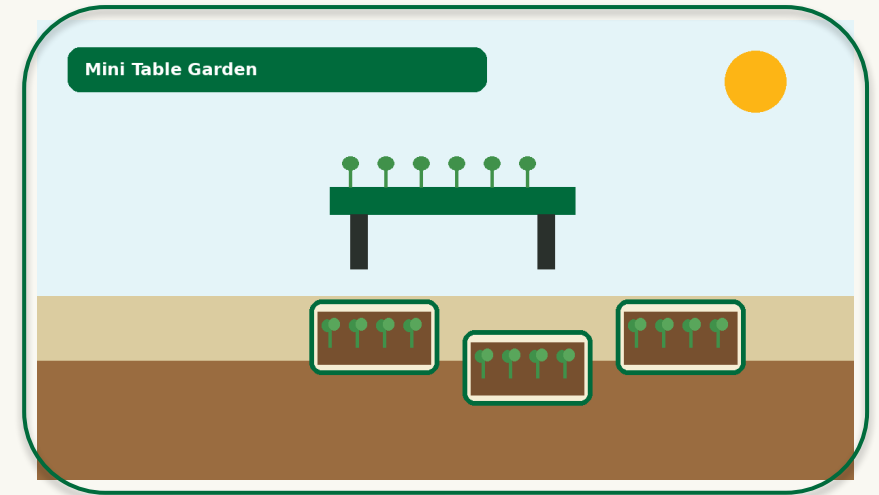


Mini Table Garden

Teaching at the Growing Table

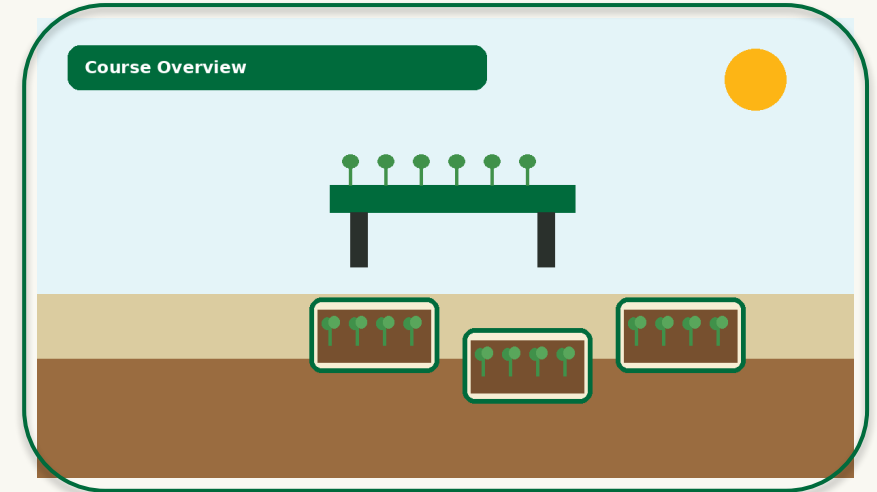
- LIFEWS AgriShine™ GrowMeal™ Nursery Teacher Training
- Audience: Nursery teachers, teaching assistants and garden facilitators
- Format: Self-paced online course + supervised practical orientation
- Recommended duration: 2 hours 30 minutes online + 60 minutes garden practical



Course Overview

Learning outcomes, materials and completion requirements

- By the end of the course, teachers should be able to explain the garden's learning purpose, prepare age-appropriate activities, facilitate the ten course topics, manage children safely outdoors, and document learning through observation.
- Recommended materials: teacher guide; picture/word cards appropriate to the garden; child-safe tools where needed; watering equipment; observation sheets; drawing materials; labels; handwashing supplies; first-aid access.
- Completion: review all modules, complete the practical teacher task, and demonstrate safe supervision of one short garden lesson.



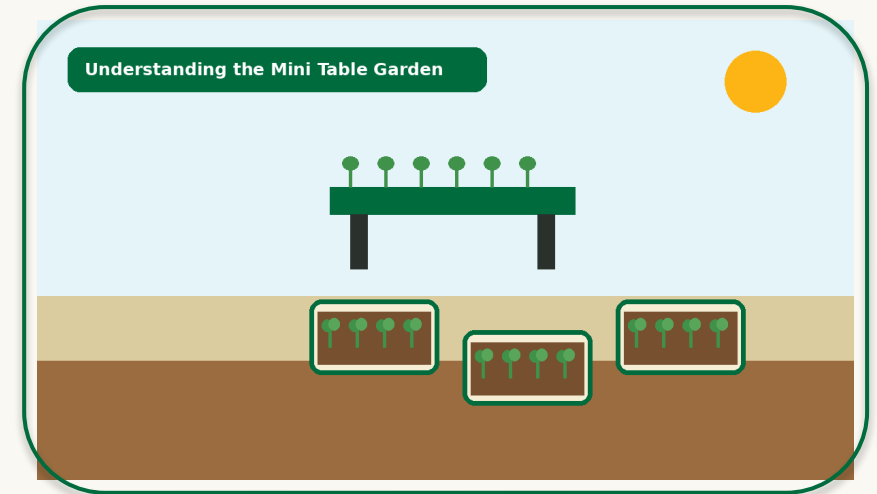
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Training principle: concrete experience first, simple language second, repetition throughout.

Understanding the Mini Table Garden

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- A Mini Table Garden brings crops to a comfortable working height for close observation and guided care.
- It supports small-group teaching and can improve access for children who find ground-level beds difficult.
- Tables must be stable, appropriately sized and designed for drainage.
- Use compact crops and shallow-rooted plants suited to the system.
- Teacher routine: GATHER → DEMONSTRATE → DO → OBSERVE → CLEAN.



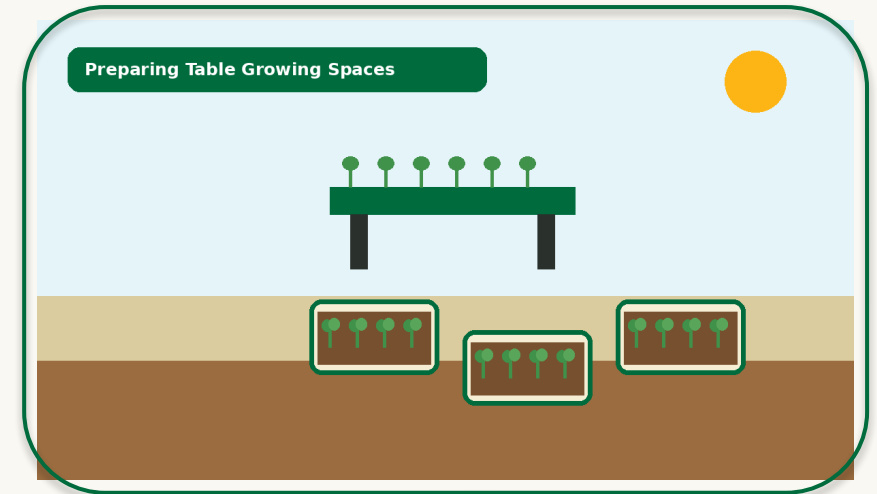
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Inspect table height, stability and access routes.

Preparing Table Growing Spaces

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Check structural stability, bed liners if used, drainage and growing-media depth.
- Keep edges smooth and corners rounded or protected.
- Leave enough space around tables for supervised movement.
- Prepare labels, tools and water before children arrive.
- Do not overload tables beyond their designed capacity.



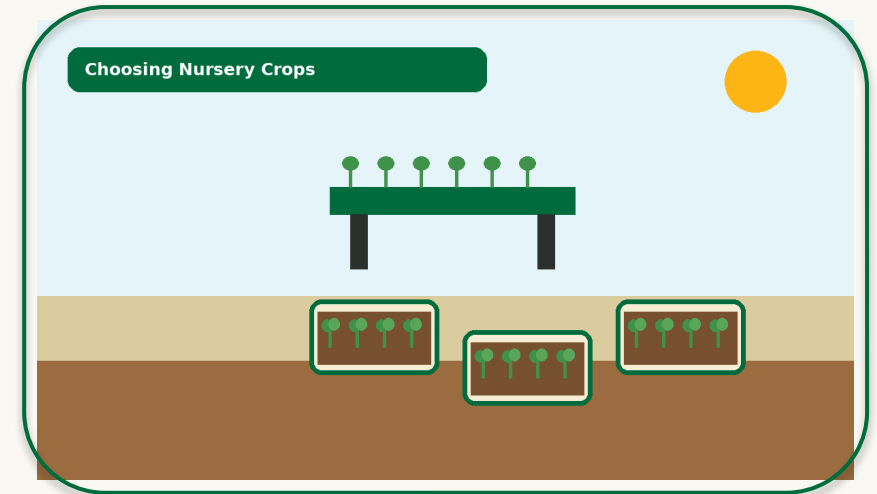
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Teacher check: STABLE • ACCESSIBLE • DRAINING • CLEAR.

Choosing Nursery Crops

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Choose compact, quick-growing, non-thorny crops appropriate to table depth and local conditions.
- Use familiar leafy vegetables and herbs where suitable.
- Consider color, smell and texture for sensory learning.
- Avoid plants known to be toxic, irritating or too large for the structure.
- Follow the garden program's approved crop plan.



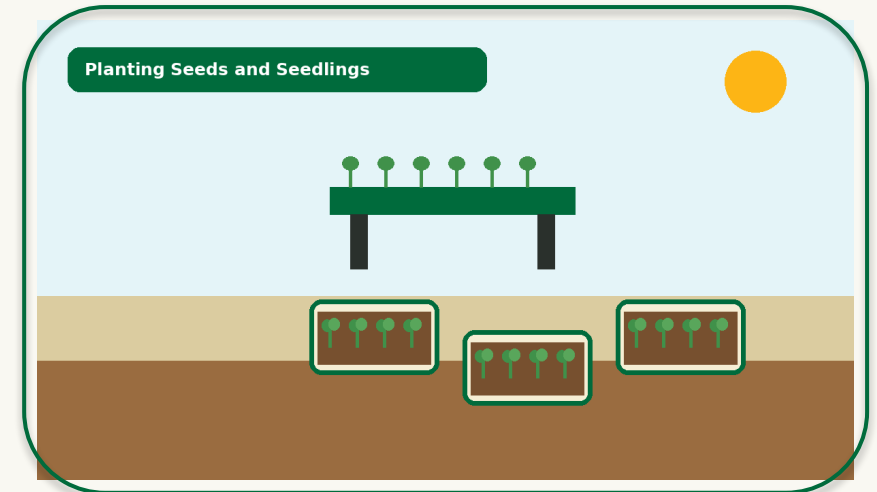
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Select a simple two-crop table plan.

Planting Seeds and Seedlings

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Demonstrate seed versus seedling before planting.
- Use child-safe hand tools or fingers where appropriate.
- Keep planting depth and spacing suitable to the crop.
- Give children small, clearly marked planting zones.
- Finish by watering gently and naming what was planted.



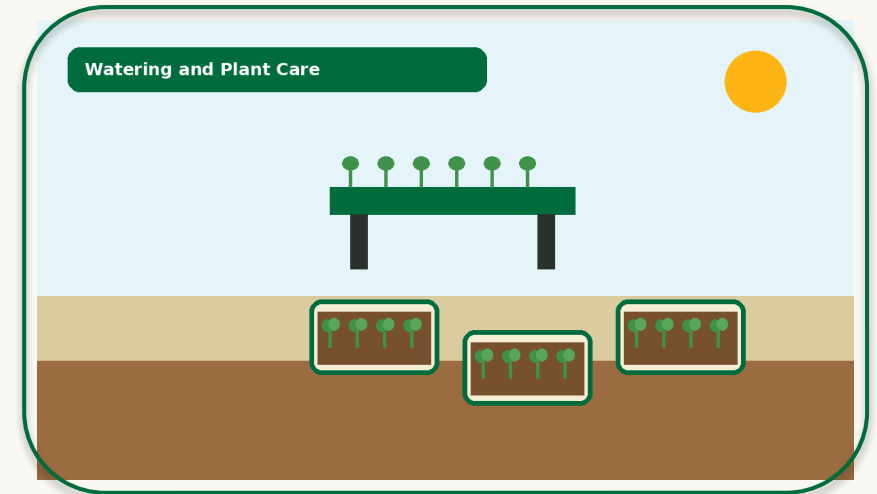
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare one seed activity and one seedling activity.

Watering and Plant Care

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Check moisture before watering.
- Use small watering cans or controlled drip lines.
- Teach gentle removal of obvious weeds only after the teacher identifies them.
- Observe leaf color and plant posture as simple care indicators.
- Keep drainage outlets clear and clean spills promptly.



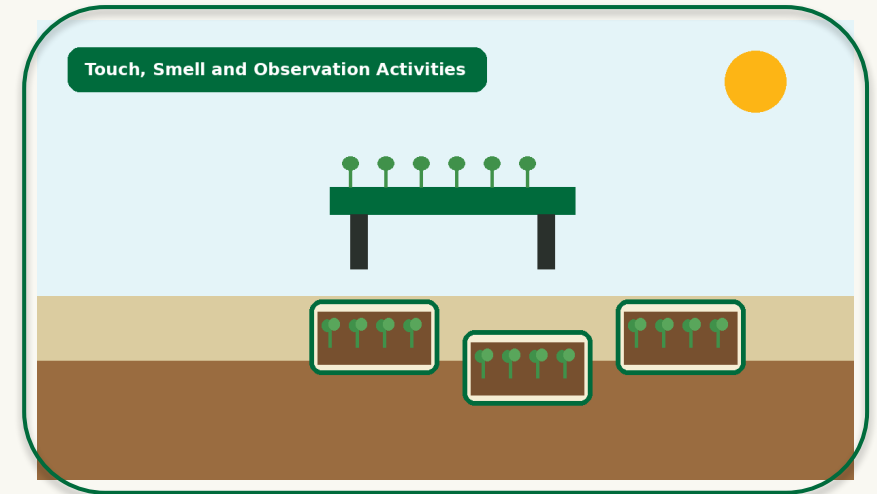
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Create a short daily/weekly care routine.

Touch, Smell and Observation Activities

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Select safe plants specifically for sensory interaction.
- Ask children to look before touching and smell only approved plants.
- Use describing words: soft, rough, smooth, green, small, strong smell, light smell.
- Never require tasting as part of sensory learning.
- Rotate small groups so plants are not overhandled.



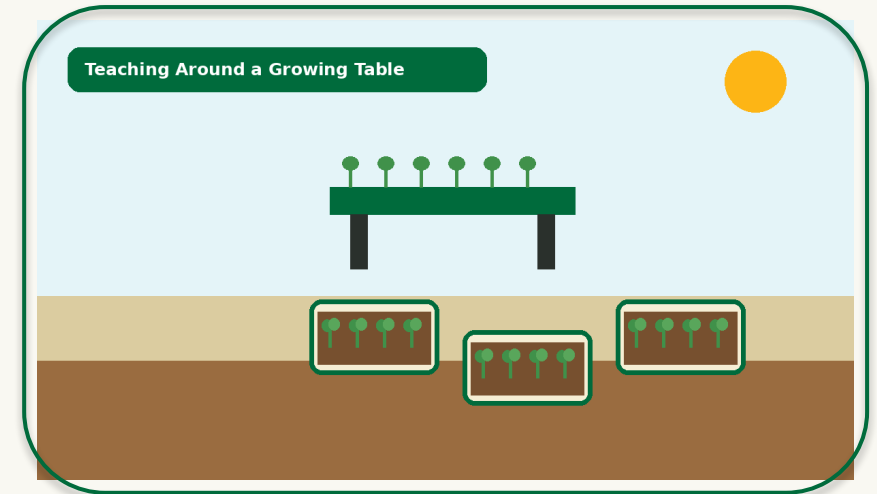
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Identify three safe sensory plants or materials.

Teaching Around a Growing Table

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Gather children where all can see the demonstration.
- Use stations or assigned sides of the table to prevent crowding.
- Keep explanations short and action-based.
- Use the table for vocabulary, counting, comparison, drawing and care tasks.
- End with a brief reflection away from tools and water.



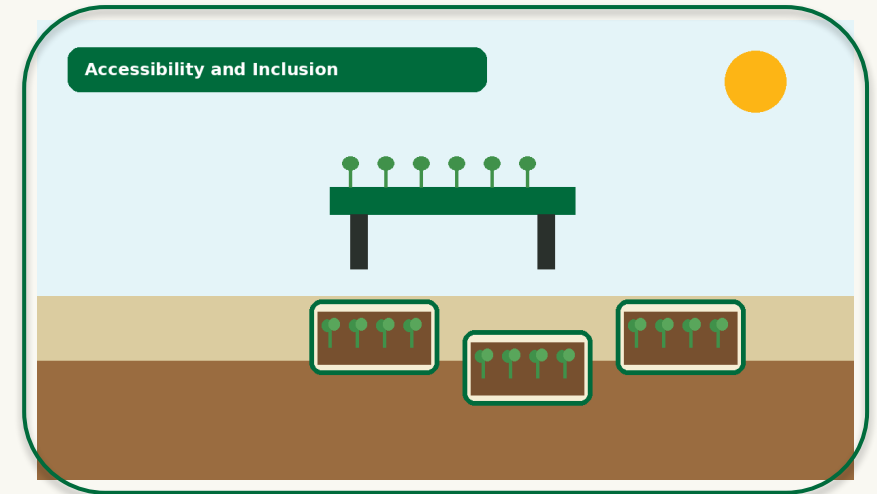
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Plan a 25–30 minute table-garden lesson routine.

Accessibility and Inclusion

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Provide clear approach space and avoid blocking pathways.
- Place frequently used materials within safe reach.
- Offer equivalent roles: observing, pointing, watering, labeling, drawing or counting.
- Do not assume every child can stand, grip tools or tolerate all textures.
- Adapt participation while keeping the same learning goal.
- Follow school accessibility and support plans.



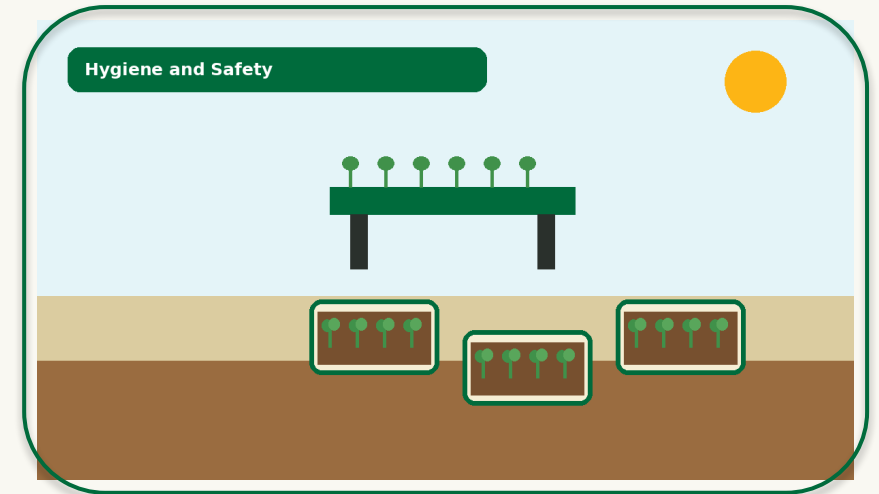
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Identify at least three alternative participation roles.

Hygiene and Safety

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Check table stability and surfaces before use.
- Keep tools age-appropriate and supervised.
- Clean water spills to prevent slipping.
- Do not permit tasting without approved food-hygiene procedures.
- Wash hands after garden activities.
- Follow school procedures for allergies, weather and first aid.



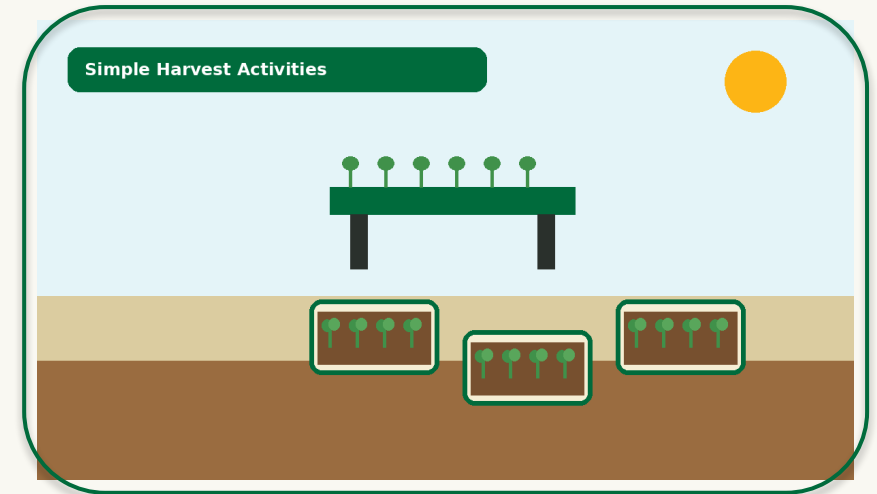
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Complete a table-and-path safety inspection.

Simple Harvest Activities

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Harvest only crops identified as ready by the teacher.
- Demonstrate gentle picking or cutting; adults handle tools not approved for children.
- Count, sort or compare harvested items as learning extensions.
- Keep harvested produce off dirty surfaces.
- Use approved washing/food-handling procedures if produce will be eaten.
- Celebrate the connection between care and food production.



TEACHER PRACTICE

- Completion task: design a planting-to-harvest table-garden activity.